

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS AT LITTLE Rock TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: February 26–27, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an on-site review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two

BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two
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UA LITTLE ROCK

TRADITIONAL ROUTE

Overall Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
APPROACHING	MEETS	APPROACHING

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

Standard 1 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	MEETS
Recommendations		
Recruiting additional candidates to increase overall enrollment, particularly in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a and 1.2b)</i>		

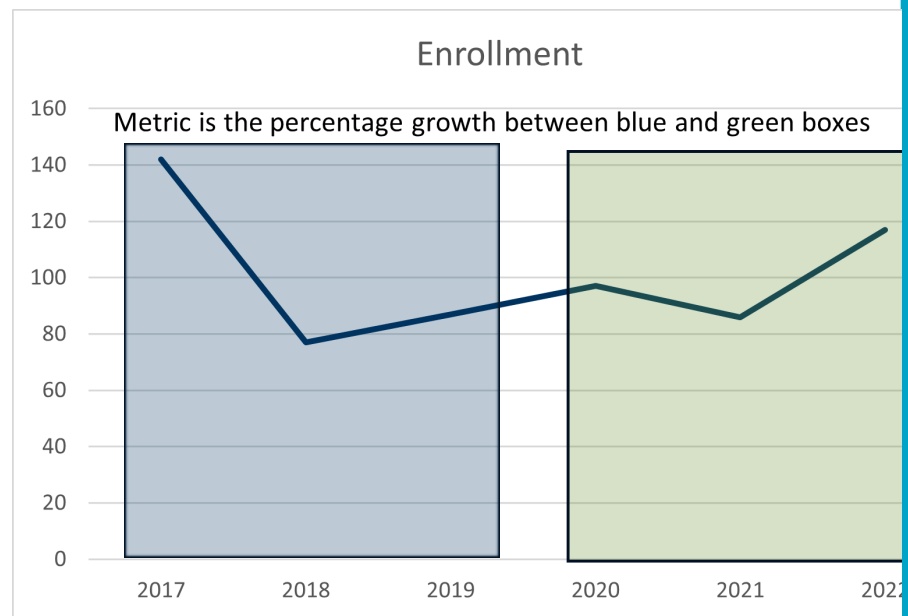
INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	EPPs were not asked to submit formal plans to meet the state review framework targets or to show evidence of acting on their plans as part of the Spring 2024 review cycle. As a result, all EPPs in this cycle will receive a rating of MEETS.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	-2%	APPROACHING



*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a "Meets" rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an "Exceeds" rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need

Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	17%	APPROACHING

Shortage Area Enrollment

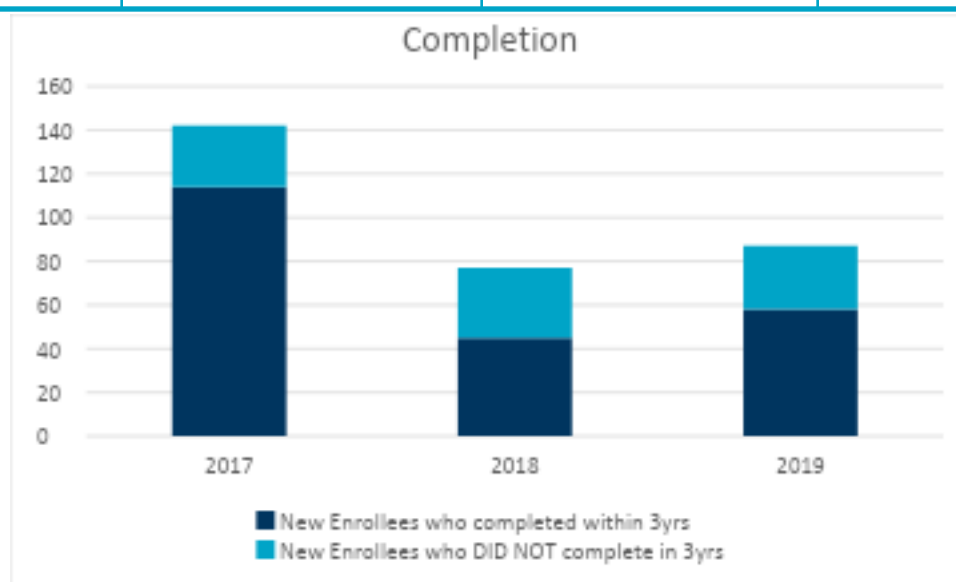
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*Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas. Current licensure areas of shortage: Computer Science (4-12), Biology (7-12), Chemistry (7-12), Physics (7-12), Foreign Language (K-12), Math (7-12), Math (4-8), Science (4-8), Special Education (K-12)

INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion

Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	71%	MEETS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
APPROACHING	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
The clear and intentional alignment of coursework and clinical experience is a strength at UA Little Rock. Candidates can reflect on the alignment with clinical supervisors and course instructors. The collaboration with Jacksonville School District to co-construct the clinical internship is very strong, as is candidate development. Candidates show evidence that they can impact student growth. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - Audit coursework for classroom connections, ensuring that instructors provide models of instruction and clearly and intentionally familiarize candidates with 2023 Arkansas K-12 Standards. This includes providing opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout all grade bands within their licensure area and ensuring that an increase in coursework rigor is clear to students so they can see how one course builds off another. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1a Metric 2, Criteria 2.1b Metric 2)</i> - Document a clear and intentional process to select mentor teachers and expand the model used to partner and collaborate with Jacksonville to other districts. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 2.2b Metric 2, 2.2c Metric 1)</i> - Support candidates so that not only struggling candidates receive extra support but also high performers receive opportunities and feedback that encourage retention. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 2.3b Metric 4)</i> - UA Little Rock should continue planning to meet the state's one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond. Note: During the on-site review the K-6 Program of Study is not approved by the DESE. Action is needed by UA Little Rock to work toward compliance.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based APPROACHING
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS
Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction. Multiple documents were submitted as evidence that illustrated this, including syllabi that included best practices for utilizing technology in education and detailed objective mapping for the elementary pathway courses. Middle-level

Literacy and Language Arts utilize current research and texts on best practices. The UA Little Rock faculty also worked with US Prep to consider student assessments, make data-informed decisions, and develop courses.

In the course observations, reviewers saw evidence of using high-quality instructional materials. For example, the ELEM 4304 Seminar in ELEM and ELEM 4301 Language and Literacy course descriptions provided an outline for using HQIM, including assignments for scaffolding, formative assessment, and assessing students' prior knowledge. In the Course Instructors' focus group, it was stated that the teaching candidates utilize the same materials from their field experience classes in their coursework. Wit and Wisdom is one of the curricula utilized. In the Coursework focus group, participants also discussed using the same curriculum as the school district for course assignments. In the Clinical Experience focus group, three out of four teaching candidates discussed using HQIM in their classrooms. The reviewers also saw evidence-based practices incorporated into the coursework. For example, participants in the Course Instructor focus group shared that CEC's High-Leverage Practices, best practices for special educators and teacher candidates, are infused in the special education courses and incorporated in most other courses also.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K-12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

APPROACHING

The coursework somewhat familiarizes candidates with the 2023 Arkansas K-12 Standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. Most courses listed relevant standards in the syllabi; however, the evidence provided did not clearly show how they are incorporated into the assignments.

Coursework provides candidates with some opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout grade bands within the licensure area. Although candidates mentioned having access to the standards in lesson preparation with their mentor teacher, reviewers did not see evidence of this in coursework.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

APPROACHING

Courses are somewhat sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework, providing candidates an opportunity to show proficiency. The documents provided show a clear sequence and alignment in the "Programs of Study for Education Minor" document, BSE Elementary K-6, and BSE Middle Childhood 4-8. There are reinforcement opportunities for candidates in that they take all courses in one subject in a semester, and some of the content is repetitive. Although CED 4310 Middle-Level Content Literacy provides a chart in the syllabus that shows how this class was built from previous courses' materials and assignments, it was not clear in the rest of the evidence provided nor in the coursework observed that there is a progressive increase in rigor across all courses.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

APPROACHING

Coursework somewhat incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills required for their required licensure area. All matrices submitted showed alignment with ATS or Educator Competencies. However, in the evidence provided, it was unclear how this alignment is articulated to candidates in the facilitation of the course.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

In the documents provided, the evidence shows that coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experiences through pre-requisite and concurrent courses. Many strong links between the courses and clinical experiences are illustrated in the documents submitted. For example, the "ARED Program Handbook" says, "The field experience components of the degree begin with student observations that progress into guided teaching opportunities." In ENGL 4600, ARED 4129 Art Education Practicum Syllabus, and HIST 4197/5197 Social Studies Teaching Practicum, there are course observations and POP cycles as well as reflection sessions to help students connect and unpack their experience in their internship. POP cycles are coaching cycles that include pre-observation meetings, an observation, and a post-observation meeting. Regarding HIST 4197, one reviewer noted, "It's very clear that the instructor is extremely hands-on in monitoring candidate progress and experience of the internship." In the Program Director focus group, one participant explained that the entire program structure was created to be intentionally aligned. For example, in their first experience, participants participated in math and science K12 classes

while also completing coursework pertaining to math and science. Reviewers saw this alignment during course observations too. In ELEM 3301, coursework is aligned to clinical experience by directly showing candidates what to look for in clinical placements: vocabulary strategies, highlighting classroom management strategies (particularly around attention strategies – looking to the front of the room, 1,2,3 freeze, clapping), and showing ways to check for understanding (choral response, respond or pass) in classrooms.

Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. Besides the reflection examples listed above, one participant in the Coursework focus group described how they had to research the K-12 Standards for lesson planning and how the course instructor encouraged them to talk to their mentor teacher. After sharing their lesson plan with their mentor, they discussed implementation strategies for the classroom. All participants agreed that they discussed coursework lesson planning with their mentor teachers.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K12 Standards, content knowledge, and pedagogy. For example, the “University of Arkansas School of Education and EPP Faculty Credentials” document shows that most instructors have a terminal degree, and their recent professional development and conference attendance is recorded. From the “Faculty Evaluation” materials, it is clear that there is an annual evaluation of instructors that includes a self-assessment.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show evidence of strong coursework facilitation. For example, the “Qualtrics UALR Evaluation Collection of Student Course Evaluation” document illustrates that an evaluation process is in place for all full-time and adjunct professors. There is also a system for self-evaluation. No evaluation results were provided. In the documents and courses observed, there was also evidence of feedback and support. The HIST 4397/5397 Teaching Applications syllabus shows that students receive peer and instructor feedback on curriculum planning, practice teaching in small group sessions, and then revise and resubmit their lesson plans as many times as needed to achieve proficiency.

In one course observation, READ 3322, the course instructor employed various teaching strategies that she connected to an elementary classroom. After providing feedback on a lesson, while students were working together and independently, she moved around the room, checked in on progress, and offered help and suggestions. In another course observation, ART 4328, the course instructor modeled strong facilitation. All students were actively engaged in the discussion, in the feedback loop, and in problem-solving around differentiation across student groups and strategies to support all learners.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. Reviewers saw evidence of this in the following documents. The “SPED Handbook” indicates clinical experiences in coursework leading up to both internship semesters. The “Middle-Level Field Internship Overview” shows two semesters of field experience with increasing hours and assignments before the internship semester. The music and SPED degree plans indicate a building of coursework before field experience. The “Handbook for Internships” indicates the specific assignments and timeline expected for field one—and two-semester assignments, which build clinical experiences throughout the program.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, all participants agreed that there was a range of experiences with gradual release in their clinical experiences. The experiences progressed from observing, assessing, co-teaching, and watching the model to teaching full-time in their internship.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs, as evidenced by the following documents: the syllabus for ARED 4310 includes field hours for differentiated learning experiences for art students; TCED 3302 has field hours for observation in the field incorporating assignments about child development; ELEM 4300 has field hours tied directly to observing and reflecting on assessments from the field placement; the "SPED Program Handbook" highlights field hours and assignments tied to multiple courses in the "Handbook for Special Needs Classrooms".

UA Little Rock evidence contains partner school information indicating a variety of student populations for candidate placements. The "Residency Handbook" also details a yearlong, possibly paid residency option being piloted to continue and increase the number of candidates in Jacksonville District next year.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, participants spoke about working with students in Special Education, students with dyslexia and learning disabilities, and with ELL students. They shared that all participants have experiences in grades K-2, 3-4 with the opportunity to choose to work in a different school, and 5-6 again with the chance to work in a different school. The evidence supports that candidates are placed in varied field experiences and provided with placements in varied schools, some high-performing, and some low-performing. In the clinical observation videos, reviewers noted that candidates are provided various field experiences working with varied learners, as evidenced by the observations. During the first observation, the candidate discussed the struggles of students who have IEPs. The clinical supervisor then provided examples of ways to help scaffold for the students as they progressed.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. UA Little Rock provided evidence of a Mentor Teacher Orientation and continued training throughout the year to prepare and norm mentor teachers on their roles and expectations. One example provided is the Wakefield /Pinnacle View Mentor Teacher Training. It is administered by UA Little Rock faculty and covers coaching strategies and teacher candidate development. The mentor conducts evaluations for the candidates in field placement and provides feedback. Sixty-five percent of the mentors have training in the TESS Rubric. Eighty-one percent of mentors have taught for at least five years, and all are licensed. In the clinical experience focus group, all four participants said they had supportive mentor teachers who encouraged them and gave daily feedback. One participant talked about how they struggled at the beginning of their clinical experience. They talked to their mentor teacher, who helped them access school platforms at home, find additional resources to keep at home, and institute a weekly planning meeting. In the Mentor Teacher focus group, they shared that they all had years of experience teaching, training in reading, master's degrees, and mentoring experience. One mentor discussed modeling "think alouds" for her candidate while teaching to explain why she was making instructional decisions.

Note: By 2026-2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training must be shown to meet this metric

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

APPROACHING

There is no clear selection process outlined for mentor teachers, though they strive to ensure mentors meet criteria based on four primary areas: educational criteria, instructions, effectiveness, dispositions, and professionalism. One document suggests the principal recommends mentors, but reviewers did not observe an intentional process from the evidence provided.

Note: By 2026-2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have a minimum 3 years teaching experience, hold a standard Arkansas educators license with a Lead or Master Professional

Educator designation, and have evidence of an annual rating of effective or higher in DESE's Educator Effectiveness System must be shown to meet this metric

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. As evidenced in the documents submitted, all clinical supervisors have experience teaching and coaching and have continued their learning and development. The "Coaching Information" spreadsheet contains a log of coaching sessions for each teaching candidate. All four Clinical Experience focus group participants had a positive experience with their clinical supervisor. They discussed their clinical supervisor's responsiveness and thought partnering around classroom challenges. One participant gave the example of herself and her mentor teacher being overwhelmed by a student's actions (hitting, rolling on the floor, flipping desks, etc.). The clinical supervisor helped the participant and mentor create a "First Then Board" reward system to support the student and learning environment.

In the School Partnership focus group, participants stated that clinical supervisors show evidence of effective instructional practice and coaching being knowledgeable about the HQIM utilized by each district and bringing it into their coursework. They also mentioned that the clinical supervisors are highly qualified teachers who provide professional development to candidates during Friday seminar courses.

In the Coaching Session observations, three out of four observations were strong with a positive impact, as illustrated by the following details: The coach reviewed the Aspiring Teacher Rubric metric by metric with the candidate as a self-assessment and gave feedback on each metric and then asked the candidate for ways they could move to the next level. In another video, the coach reviewed the lesson and student data with the candidate and gave specific examples of ways to improve as well as positive feedback in areas the candidate was exceeding (an example was the coach's praise for the candidate's clear objectives and how she was able to help students fully grasp the objective).

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

MEETS

Candidates consistently receive high-quality feedback from their experienced mentor teachers and clinical supervisors. The documents submitted include the "Coaching Information Spreadsheet" which outlines multiple feedback and coaching sessions per teaching candidate. The "POP Cycle Feedback and Walkthrough Feedback Form" documents are effective templates for delivering feedback to teaching candidates and are aligned to TESS. The "Site Coordinator Handbook" indicated at least eight annual walkthroughs and four POP cycles.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

APPROACHING

Collaborative processes are in place with some districts to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates. The UA Little Rock / LRSD landing page submitted as evidence shows strong effort and collaboration between LRSD and UA Little Rock, indicating aligned work and communication between supervisors and mentors. The "UA Little Rock / Jacksonville Governance Agreements" also show strong effort in the residency plan with Jacksonville and collaborative work between clinical supervisors and mentors. However, the "Handbooks for the Elementary Program" and agreements for elementary placements indicated some collaboration but not to the extent of LRSD and Jacksonville.

The School Partnership focus group corroborated this. There was evidence that a collaborative process exists with the EPP and one district in developing a Field Experience Handbook. The site coordinators conduct governance meetings with district administration and principals to share data on POP cycles and classroom walk-throughs. This data is used to drive the seminar instruction for candidates. Also, candidates have the opportunity to attend all professional development offered by the district.

Another example of the partnership between the EPP and some districts revolves around the residency experience. Training took place with mentors to provide an outline of expectations. Additionally, onsite training occurs between UA Little Rock and the mentors. There is also a set progression point, and all the candidates were at the appropriate

goal toward taking over the classroom. These touchpoints and the communication are evidence that the EPP and partners in the residency model are strong and aligned.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes that support and develop effective clinical supervisors are consistently in place. This is evidenced by documents such as the "US Prep Clinical Convening" document demonstrating work to train supervisors. The clinical supervisors attended supervisor training in San Diego through US Prep.

Clinical supervisors regularly complete professional development and learning opportunities. Staff retreats and faculty agendas show that they frequently meet to discuss findings, data, and improvements to the program.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. In the evidence submitted, the database showing mastery of coursework shows all but one teaching candidate who graduated with a 3.5 GPA or above, and 86% passed their Praxis exam. In the Coursework focus group, candidates felt most participants showed proficiency in coursework requirements through exams, teacher checks for understanding, term projects, grades in Blackboard, and conversations during office hours.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

The evidence from the "SOE Student Policies and Procedures" manual shows that candidates are provided with an individualized support plan if they are not on track in their coursework. Additionally, there is a system for course instructors to submit dispositional concerns. The "Teacher Candidate Growth Plan" outlines a clear plan, action items, and deadlines to support teachers in monitoring progress.

In the Coursework focus group, participants discussed the support they receive each semester from their advisor before registering for courses. One participant said their advisor is helpful because "they know all the professors and have supported [the teaching candidates] each year." They also mentioned that course instructors are very responsive and willing to help support students in coursework.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

The documents indicate that programs have clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internships. For example, the coaching cycle (POP Cycle) states clear goals and milestones aligned with the Aspiring TESS indicators. Most students meet the GPA requirement (Elementary Education Internship Evaluation Data) and meet expectations, as evidenced by the POP Cycle data.

Evidence is provided showing candidates have goals and milestones for clinical experiences. This evidence includes the "Pilot Performance Gates", "Elementary Education Summative Evaluation" scores, and handbooks. The handbooks provide the expectations for candidates throughout their field experiences. The piloted Gates provides the expectations for candidates as they move through the POP cycles with a sample growth plan. Additionally, this year, POP cycle data was provided to residents. Scores of candidates' summative evaluations over the last four years show the overall growth of candidates. The mentor teacher feedback form was also provided. It appears this feedback is generated weekly.

The evidence provided in the Program Director focus group shows that the UA Little Rock team is working to sequence coursework for all programs by creating performance gates, feedback from previous TPI-US visits, and working with US Prep.

In the coaching observation, the traditional route candidate met clinical experience goals and milestones. She had a post-conference packet that highlights her growth in proficiency over the semester and underscores the planning and preparation for the classes she teaches. The packet also included feedback from her clinical supervisor on each aspect of the coaching rubric and the candidate's progress.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. The uploaded evidence of observation data indicates improvement in teaching, which leads to improvement in student learning. The evidence details how candidates assess and provide feedback to students about their performance. Additionally, candidates determine how to modify an academic change plan for special education students based on various academic needs through pre-assessments, interventions, and post-assessments. This is a required case study in candidates' special education program. Exit tickets and student polls (Analysis of Student Work) show that students are learning.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, all 4 participants described how they impact student growth. One participant gave an assessment every week and would pull small groups of students after analyzing data with the mentor teacher. They saw an improvement in letters, sounds, and digraphs on the exit tickets. Another participant discussed how she uses pre- and post-assessment student data with her clinical supervisor.

Reviewers also saw evidence of this in the "Coaching Session" observations. For example, a clear outline of student data and growth is discussed, and student data is provided in the post-conference packet. The data showed that out of 19 students, 15 moved up at least one level. All four Coaching Session observation videos showed student growth.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive an "effective" score on the TESS or Aspiring Teacher Rubric. Evidence shows that candidates met the criteria on the TESS (or Aspiring Teacher Rubric) based on average scores. Evidence was provided for candidates' average scores of 3.32, 2.9, 3.11 and 2.97 on the TESS rubric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

APPROACHING

Candidates with varied needs seem to be provided with the support they need. Evidence shows that candidates are supported throughout their clinical internships. Handbooks for elementary and special education programs and the "School of Education Policy Manual" provide expectations, requirements, and policies. A coaching document also shows evidence of clinical supervisors providing candidates with coaching sessions anywhere from 25 to 30 sessions by the time of program completion. However, the reviewers did not see evidence of individualized support plans if a candidate's development in the clinical internship was not on track. No evidence was submitted that most high-performing candidates receive opportunities and feedback encouraging retention.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
BELOW	EXCEEDS	BELOW
Recommendations		
UA Little Rock's traditional program completers struggle to become licensed within one year of completion. However, three years after completion, completers become licensed, work in Arkansas public schools and districts (including priority districts and subjects) and stay in the classroom for multiple years. While UA Little Rock traditional completers have more above-average value-added scores than the state average, neither program completers nor their supervisors hold a strong perception of their preparedness to be effective in the classroom. Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that traditional program completers are prepared to obtain standard licensure immediately following completion, including passing the content exam on their first try. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.1a and 3.1c)</i> - Analyze EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify specific domains and components for which both supervisors and candidates do not feel their program prepared them well to become a teacher. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3a and 3.3b)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license	76%	47%	BELOW

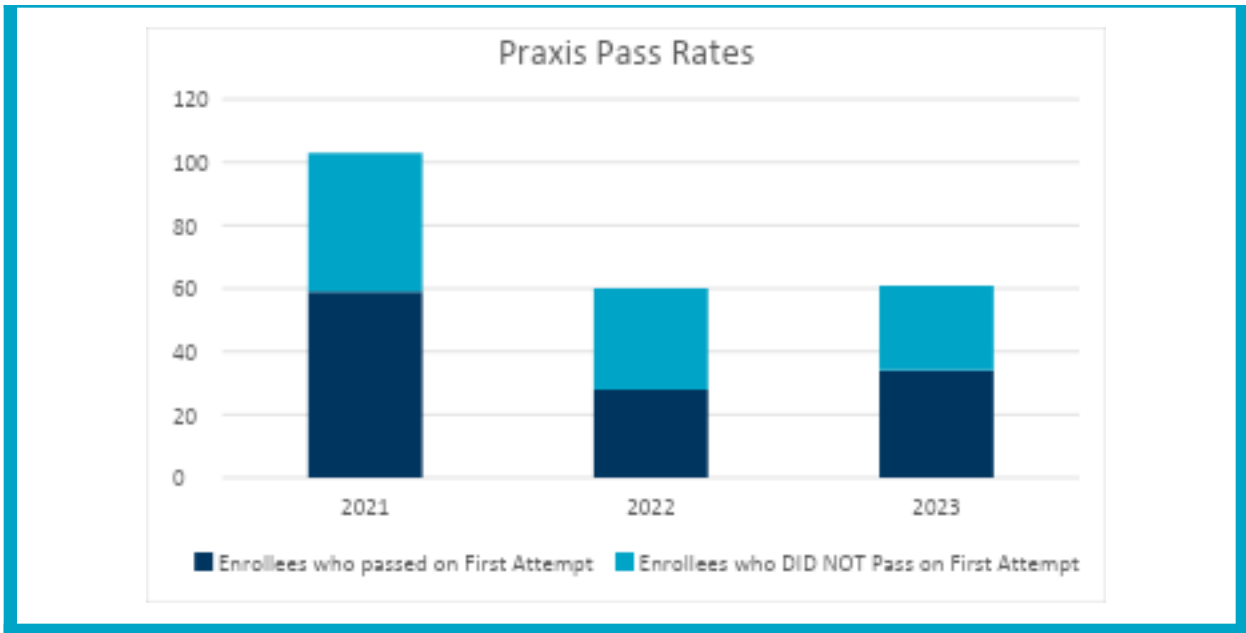


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	69%	n/a	n/a

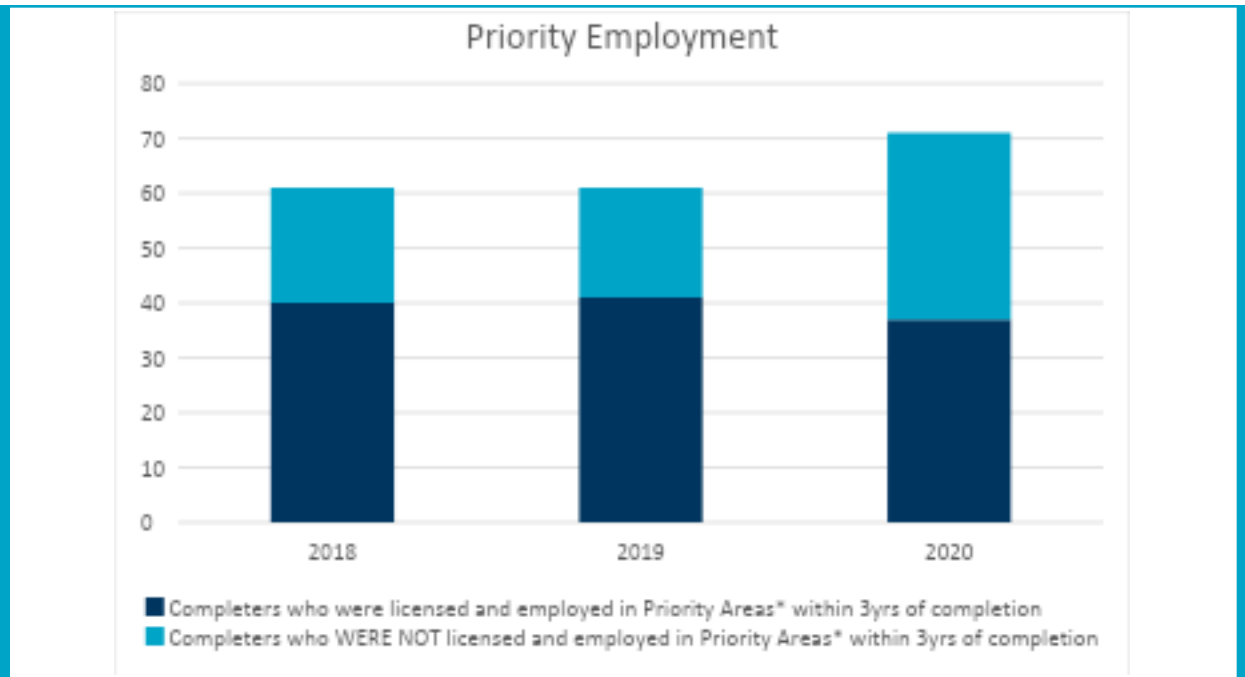
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	54%	BELOW



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	73.1%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><caption>Employment Data</caption><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Completers who were licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion</th><th>Completers who WERE NOT licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2018</td><td>50%</td><td>10%</td></tr><tr><td>2019</td><td>48%</td><td>12%</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>42%</td><td>29%</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Completers who were licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion	Completers who WERE NOT licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion	2018	50%	10%	2019	48%	12%	2020	42%	29%
Year	Completers who were licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion	Completers who WERE NOT licensed and employed within 3yrs of completion													
2018	50%	10%													
2019	48%	12%													
2020	42%	29%													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	61.1%	EXCEEDS												



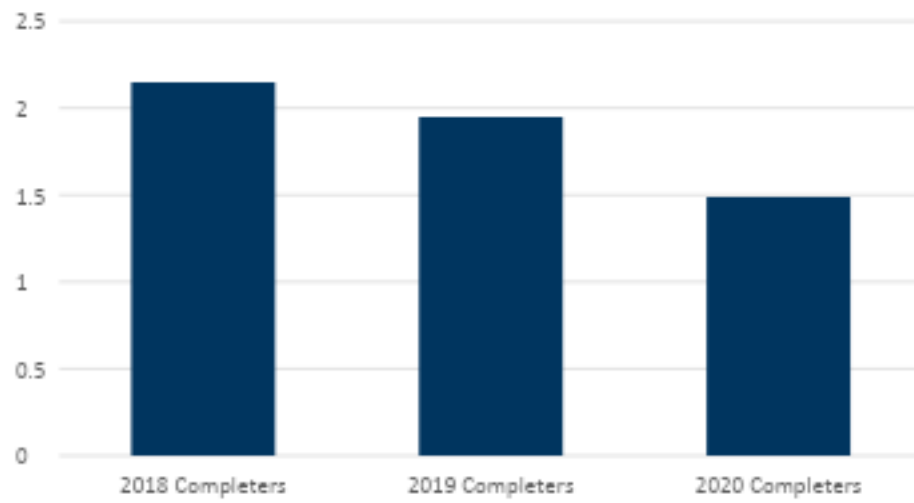
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	1.84	EXCEEDS

Average experience three years after completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	81%	64.7%	BELOW
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	75%	61.5%	BELOW
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	45%	EXCEEDS

